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THE SPEED OF ADAPTATION

NOT EVERY PRESSURE EXCEEDS CAPACITY BECAUSE OF ITS MAGNITUDE.
IT CAN ALSO EXCEED IT BECAUSE OF ITS **SPEED**.

CAPACITY
TIME

PRESSURE
SPEED



PRESSURE × SPEED ↔ **CAPACITY × TIME**

WHAT HAPPENS WHEN THE TERRITORY NEEDS
MORE TIME TO ADAPT THAN THE CHANGE ALLOWS?



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THE SPEED OF ADAPTATION

The factor that is often left out

When pressure on a territory is assessed, the usual question concerns its magnitude.

How much heat.

How much extraction.

How much population.

How much infrastructure.

How much demand.

How much change.

But there is another decisive variable:

the speed at which that pressure is incorporated into the system.

A territory may have the capacity to absorb a transformation and yet not have the time required to do so.

Capacity does not act instantaneously.

Soil needs time.

An aquifer needs time.

A forest needs time.

A population needs time.

Infrastructure needs time.

An ecosystem needs time.

That is why two pressures of equal magnitude can produce completely different consequences.

The difference may not lie in how much the system changes, but in how much time it has to adapt while it is changing.

Capacity does not mean immediate availability

Saying that a territory has capacity does not mean that this capacity is available at any moment or at any speed.

Territorial capacity is **situated, limited, and temporal**.

It depends on the system's prior conditions:

- soil condition;
- water availability;
- accumulated temperature;
- ecological continuity;
- existing infrastructure;
- prior human pressure;
- institutional capacity;
- biological recovery margin.

A system close to its limit may still appear to retain capacity.

But its margin for adaptation may already have been drastically reduced.

That is why the question should not be only:

Can it withstand it?

It should also be:

Can it adapt at this speed?

Acceleration as territorial pressure

Contemporary acceleration introduces an additional difficulty.

Many transformations do not arrive in isolation.

They overlap.

Heat.

Drought.

Wildfires.

Energy consumption.

Mobility.

Tourism.

Infrastructure.

Production.

Urbanization.

Social demands.

Each pressure can be analyzed separately and may appear manageable.

But the territory does not receive them separately.

It receives them simultaneously and within the same available time.

The question therefore ceases to be:

Is there capacity for each pressure?

And becomes:

Is there enough capacity to respond to all of them at the speed at which they are arriving?

A situated reading

BIOIA / WUOM does not propose establishing a universal threshold for adaptation.

The threshold depends on the territory.

The same pressure may be tolerable in one place and critical in another.

The same speed may be manageable in one season and excessive in another.

The reading requires observing simultaneously:

PRESSURE

what is arriving;

SPEED

how quickly it is changing;

CAPACITY

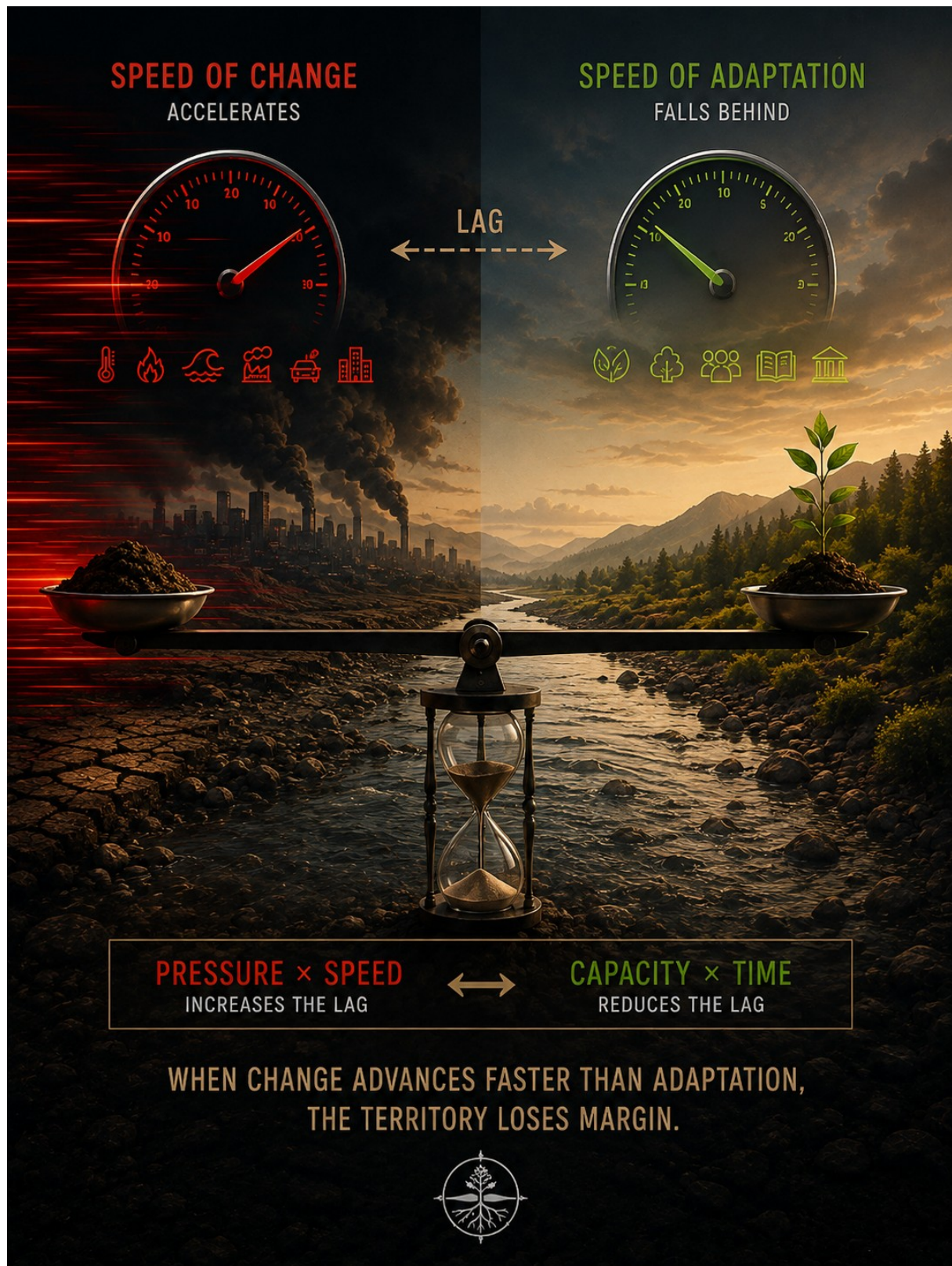
what real margin the system still retains;

TIME

how long it needs to respond.

The aim is not to predict exactly when a territory will fail.

It is to detect when the distance begins to narrow between what is being demanded of it and what it is able to process.



**WHEN CHANGE MOVES FASTER THAN ADAPTATION · THE TERRITORY
LOSES MARGIN**

Return

Adaptation does not consist of forcing the territory to keep pace with any transformation.

It can also consist of **reducing the speed of the pressure.**

Wait.

Phase.

Limit.

Redistribute.

Stop.

Reconsider.

Speed is not always an inevitable condition.

In many human processes, it is a decision.

Therefore, before asking how much change a territory can withstand, there is a prior question:

AT WHAT SPEED CAN IT ADAPT WITHOUT LOSING ITS CAPACITY FOR RETURN?

Because when change allows less time than the territory needs, adaptation ceases to be a response.

It becomes pursuit.

Orientation precedes action.

Without return, there is extraction.

TO ADAPT IS TO RESPOND WITH TIME.
TO **RETURN** IS TO RECOVER **THE RHYTHM**.



ACCELERATION
EXTRACTION
WITHOUT TIME
WITHOUT MARGIN
WITHOUT RETURN

ORIENTATION PRECEDES ACTION.
WITHOUT RETURN, THERE IS EXTRACTION.



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**ADAPTING IS RESPONDING IN TIME • RETURNING IS RECOVERING
THE RHYTHM.**

